

along — Sprint 6: Realtime, Offline & Polish

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Split out from the along — Sprint Epics, User Stories & Journey Maps document for standalone sprint planning.

Goal: the app feels reliable and collaborative on patchy travel connectivity, and every screen handles loading, empty, and error states gracefully.

User stories

ID	Story	Acceptance
6.1	As a member, I want to see a new expense someone else added without refreshing	The expense list and Balances update live via realtime subscription
6.2	As a member, I want to log an expense with no signal so it saves when I'm back online	Expense queues locally and syncs exactly once on reconnect
6.3	As a member, I want to know when I'm offline	A persistent, unobtrusive offline indicator is shown
6.4	As a user, I want notifications for balance and expense changes so I stay in the loop	Notifications fire for the events in the PRD's notification list and are controllable
6.5	As a member, I want a lightweight activity feed so I can see what's changed	Feed shows joins, itinerary additions, and new expenses without feeling like a social feed

Success criteria

- Realtime updates land within 2 seconds under normal connectivity.
- 100% of offline-queued expenses sync exactly once, with zero duplicates, across a simulated flaky-network test suite.
- Every screen in the inventory has a defined loading, empty, error, and offline state (Definition of Done checklist complete).
- Notification opt-out doesn't degrade core functionality (app remains fully usable with push disabled).

User flow

1. Member A adds an expense while Member B has the app open → B's Expenses/Balances update without a manual refresh.
2. Member C loses signal mid-trip, adds an expense anyway → sees a "queued" indicator → signal returns → expense syncs, indicator clears.
3. Any member opens the Activity Feed → sees a chronological log of what changed since they last looked.

Journey map

Stage	User does	User feels	System response	Opportunity
Collaborate live	Watches a friend add an expense at dinner	Delighted it appears instantly	Realtime subscription pushes the update	Live updates are what make it feel like a shared space, not separate apps
Lose signal	Logs an expense on a hike with no bars	Anxious it might be lost	Local queue + "will sync" indicator	Make the queued state visually distinct but not alarming
Reconnect	Regains signal later	Wants confirmation nothing was lost	Queue flushes silently, indicator clears	A brief "synced" confirmation closes the loop of anxiety from the offline moment